

Kids are very smart. They will not follow rules that their parents themselves do not follow. We [my wife and I] were well-disciplined parents.... We lived the rules ... we taught by example.... They [the children] learned by example.

There must be congruency between what parents tell their children to do and what we as parents do. Kids are very perceptive in pointing out inconsistencies.

Dr. North received a birthday gift from one of his daughters when she was twelve. It was a poster titled “The King’s Rules.” On it, his daughter wrote down the rules that her father preached to his children. Dr. North still keeps this poster in his office, prominently displayed behind his desk.

Kids are looking for discipline and rules. She honored me with the poster. Kids must be trained to take responsibility for their actions. Today all my children are well disciplined and frugal. They adhered to the rules. Why? Because their parents did.... Actions speak louder than rules that are just words, not actions.

What were some of the rules Dr. North’s twelve-year-old daughter listed on the poster?

- ◆ Be tough ... life is. In other words, there is no promise of a rose garden.
- ◆ Never say “poor me” ... [or] feel sorry for yourself.
- ◆ Don’t walk on the back of your shoes.... Waste not, want not. In other words, don’t abuse your belongings. They will last longer.
- ◆ Close the front door.... Don’t waste your parents’ money letting the heat out.
- ◆ Always put things back where they belong.